Rajiv's assassination. He summoned four key operatives – Sivarasan, Murugan, Muthuraja and Baby Subramaniam and finalized the outlines of the plot.

Prabhakaran, in consultation with the Pottu Amman, cut out the task for the above four. Baby Subramaniam, an ideologue of the Tamil Tigers, would go back to Madras, increase the production of LTTE literature spewing venom against Rajiv Gandhi and rope in local, young people to distribute them. The same set of recruits would then be used to set up hideouts in Madras where the assassins could be sheltered before and after the assassination. Muthuraja too would go down to Madras along with Baby and prepare a support base in and around the city, set up UHF communication facilities, hire couriers for messages and create a channel for distribution of money to keep the assassins up and running. Murugan, an expert on explosives, will take over mission once Baby and Muthuraja had accomplished their tasks and returned to Jaffna. Sivarasan will enter the scene with the human bombs once the key assassins are in place in Madras.

The motivation behind Prabhakaran's plot gained momentum with New Delhi dissolving the DMK government led by M. Karunanidhi in Tamil Nadu. Reports filed by the state unit of the IB had suggested that the powers that be gave indulgence to indulgence to free movements of the LTTE in the state. One may recall here that Karunanidhi had repeatedly described the fellow Tamil's cause in Sri Lanka as just and noble.[16]

Someone tapped on Anirudhya's shoulder as he was lost in his own story. It was Bobb. Anirudhya stood up in a second, like a soldier at 'attention'. Bobb asked if the story was reading fine. Anirudhya fumbled. Bobb hung around a bit in the newsroom, checking with other reporters what they were up to and left. Special Correspondent Harinder Baweja, or Shammi as everyone called her, leaned over his copy. She said Bobb's body language suggested he was happy with the story.

Finally, Anirudhya felt relieved. His strength was not in 'language' but in gathering hard information from sources, contacts he had cultivated over the years. He was apprehensive about catering to *India Today*'s style of writing. That didn't seem to be a problem. Shammi said a reporter's job was